

Paula Montano

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 Paula Montano  paula-montano  PaulaMontano

Current Position

PhD Researcher *University College Dublin*

Dublin, Ireland 09/2021 - present

- Dissertation: Strategic Crisis Communication in the Council of the European Union.
- Supervision: Assoc.-Prof. James P. Cross
- Expected doctoral thesis submission: August 2025

Research Assistant *University College Dublin*

Dublin, Ireland 01/2022 - present

Projects: Irish Polling Indicator Project and Irish Politics Data with Dr. Stefan Müller

- Collect and compile demographic data from public opinion polls in Ireland *Sunday Times*, *Behaviour & Attitudes* and *RedC* polls to estimate support for parties.
- Collect and compile data from *Ireland Thinks Polls* on the most important issues in Ireland.
- Collect party manifestos in Ireland for Local and European Parliament elections and compile them into text-data. (Michael Pidgeon provided a subset of these manifestos: <https://pidgeon.ie/>)

Education

Cert Higher Education Teaching Support *University College Dublin*

2021-2022

MSc International Development *University College Dublin*

2019-2020

Dissertation: How economic satisfaction modifies the effect of levels of education on attitudes towards integration.

- Relevant Courses: Introduction to Statistics, Data Visualization in R & Research Methods for Political Science

BA International Bussiness and Foreign Affairs *Pontifical Catholic University of Ecuador*

2011-2016

Dissertation: The Role of Ecuador in the South-American Integration: UNASUR case.

- Relevant Courses: Mathematics for Finance, Finance, Accounting I and II, Foreign Aid.
- Relevant Activities: Internships in the Chamber of Commerce of Canada and Mexico. Ex-post evaluator for international cooperation projects in the Yasuni Reserve, Ecuador.

Research

Working Papers

Exceptional Measures for Exceptional Times: Deciphering Emergency Politics in the Council of the European Union (*Paula Montano*)

Crisis as a Catalyst for Rebellion: Euro Crisis in Parliamentary Debates (*Paula Montano*)

Grandstanding under the Spotlight: Unveiling Elites Crisis Communication in the Council of the European Union (*with James P. Cross and Yen-Chieh Liao*)

Work in Progress

Cross-Task Evaluation of LLMs for Text Classification (*with Lorcan McLaren; James P. Cross; Zuzanna Krakowska; Robin Rauner; Martijn Schoonvelde*)

Datasets and Code

Irish Local and EP Election Manifestos (*With Stefan Müller, Robin Rauner and Artur Baranov*)

2025

- Data: <https://github.com/stefan-mueller/iemanifestos>
- Dashboard: <https://irishpoliticsdata.shinyapps.io/manifestoexplorer/>

Irish Demographic Polling Datasets (*With Stefan Müller and Thomas Pluck*)

2024

- Data: <https://github.com/Irish-Dem-Polling/datasets>
- Dashboard: <https://irishpoliticsdata.shinyapps.io/demographicpolling/>

Research Grants and Awards

Total Value of Grants: **€81,320**

APSA Pol Com Travel Award, Political Communication Section APSA Conference	\$500 (€461)	2024
Vera E. Troeger Scholarship for Women in Political Methodology.	£1,200 (€1,409)	2024
Essex Summer School in Social Science Data Analysis, University of Essex, UK		
Research Grant School of Politics and International Relations UCD	€750	2024
PEC Travel Grant Political Studies Association of Ireland	€800	2023
Research Grant School of Politics and International Relations UCD	€600	2023
Fellowship for Women in Political Methodology (<i>Full tuition cost and accommodation</i>)		2023
University of Basel, Switzerland		
Research Grant School of Politics and International Relations UCD	€300	2022
Iseult Honohan Doctoral Scholarship UCD	€77,000	2021-2025

Teaching

University College Dublin – Undergraduate level (Head Tutor / Teaching Assistant)

POL10180: Foundations of Political Theory Spring 2025

- Prepare interactive tutorials and debates on political theory and academic writing with AI tools.

POL20050: Research Methods in Political Science Spring 2022/2023/2024

- Conduct hands-on tutorials on experimental research with the *DeclareDesign* package in R.
- Conduct hands-on tutorials for data analysis with R.
- Conduct hands-on tutorials for data analysis with STATA.

POL20010: Individuals and the State: The idea of Freedom in the History of Political Thought Autumn 2023/2024

- Conduct interactive tutorials aimed to promote critical thinking in political thought theories and contemporary issues.

INRL20160: Introduction to EU Politics Autumn 2022

- Lecture on Mastering Academic Writing Skills and the Peer Review Process.
- Provide insightful feedback on students' blog posts covering EU Politics and contemporary issues.

INRL10010: Foundations of Political Theory and International Relations Autumn 2021/2022

- Conduct engaging, interactive tutorials on political theory and international relations for four groups of 20 students, fostering critical thinking and in-depth discussions.

Conferences and Workshops

American Political Science Association 09/2024

- Featured paper: *Grandstanding in the EU? Elites crisis communication under the spotlight.*
- Philadelphia, United States

European Political Science Association 07/2024

- Featured paper: *Grandstanding under the Spotlight: Unveiling Elites Crisis Communication in the Council of the European Union.*
- Featured paper: *Exceptional Measures for Exceptional Times: Deciphering Emergency Politics in the Council of the European Union in the Euro Crisis.*
- Cologne, Germany

Standing Group in the EU Conference, ECPR 06/2024

- Featured paper: *Grandstanding under the Spotlight: Unveiling Elites Crisis Communication in the Council of the European Union.*
- Lisbon, Portugal

COMPTExT 05/2024

- Featured paper: *Grandstanding under the Spotlight: Unveiling Elites Crisis Communication in the Council of the European Union.*
- Amsterdam, Netherlands

Discourse in the Data PhD Workshop, Duitslaand Instituut Amsterdam 04/2024

- Featured paper: *Grandstanding under the Spotlight: Unveiling Elites Crisis Communication in the Council of the European Union*
- Amsterdam, Netherlands

Political Studies Association of Ireland 2022, 2023

- Featured paper: *Emergency Politics in the EU Council: Assessing European Elites Communication in the Euro Crisis.*
- Dublin, Ireland

PhD Workshop, School of Politics and International Relations, UCD 2022, 2023

- Working paper: *Emergency Politics in the EU Council: Assessing European Elites Communication in the Euro Crisis.*
- PhD project research design.

Training and Summer Schools

ECON41820 Econometrics <i>University College Dublin</i>	09/2024 – 12/2024
• <i>I audit this module to understand and use econometric techniques (masters level).</i>	
Essex Summer School in Social Science Data Analysis <i>University of Essex</i>	08/2024
• <i>Course: Ideal Point Estimation, Item Response Theory, and Scaling Methods for Surveys and Behaviour.</i>	
Oxford LLMs Workshop for Social Science Researchers <i>University of Oxford</i>	09/2023
• <i>Courses: Fundamentals of Large Language Models, Model Interpretation and Debiasing, Recent Developments: Large Language Models and Alignment and coding sessions.</i>	
Summer School for Women in Political Methodology <i>University of Basel</i>	07/2023
• <i>Courses: R packages and Functions, Advanced Graphics in R, Web-Scraping, Text Analysis, Word Embeddings, Images as Data.</i>	
Essex Summer School in Social Science Data Analysis <i>University of Essex</i>	07/2022
• <i>Course: Introduction to Quantitative Text Analysis with R</i>	

Quantitative Skills

- **Programming languages:** R, Python, STATA, Git, GitHub, L^AT_EX
- **Natural Language Processing:** Gen AI (Large Language Models), Transformers, Scaling Methods, Machine Learning

Languages

Spanish (native) - English (fluent) - French (fluent) - German (CEFR: B1)

Academic Service

PhD Representative, School of Politics and International Relations, UCD	07/2023 – present
Co-organisier, COMPTExT Conference (Hosted by UCD)	05/2022
Committee Member Diversity & Inclusion for Ad Astra Applicant Pool, UCD	01/2022
Conference Support, PSAI Conference (Hosted by UCD)	10/2021

Academic References

Dr. James P. Cross
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Associate Professor, University College Dublin

Last update: February 2025